

**OUR CUP OVERFLOWETH** Dhoni's boys after the 2011 World Cup win

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**KAPIL DEV'S EFFERVESCENCE IN '83 LIFTED THE TEAM, ALLOWED INDIAN FANS TO LIVE A DREAM LIKE NO OTHER**

transformed what seemed like a complete mismatch against the all-conquering West Indies into the most replayed moment in Indian sport (captured now forever in Hindi cinema in Kabir Khan's film, *'83*). Dev's effervescence, on and off the field, instilled self-belief in India's limited-overs skills and allowed Indian cricket fans to live a dream like no other.

In 1983, it was the entirely unexpected nature of the win that spurred a euphoric response. But while the nation rejoiced, there was always the realisation that Lords '83 was a bit of a freak, a once-in-a-generation moment that was unlikely to be repeated. By the time Dhoni's team triumphed in 2011, cricket's geographic power shift from West to East was almost complete. This, in turn, led many to hope, rather pray, that India would win the Cup on home turf. It was, after all, the last World Cup of unarguably India's most-loved cricketer, Sachin Tendulkar. Cricket may be a team sport, but Indian fans are devoted to their superstar individuals and there has been no bigger cricket deity than the God of Cricket, the baby-faced teenage prodigy we had all grown